Evicting a Client from a Shelter

Guidance for evicting a client from a shelter

Typically performed by: Shelter Site Manager
Roles likely to support task: HQ Sheltering Manager, Client Care, AD Externa lRelations

Considerations

- It is sometimes necessary to evict clients for violation of rules, physical fights, verbal abuse, disturbances, or other reasons
- Eviction usually occurs after several warnings and when efforts to resolve the issues have not the altered the situation
    - Evictions may occur without warning in cases of physical attacks or when the threat to other clients and staff is too great to allow the person to remain
- Evictions occur for individuals and not entire households.
    - Family members who are not involved in the behavior that led to the eviction are welcome to remain at the shelter
- The Shelter Site Manager has the authority to determine when a client should be evicted from a shelter
- Related Shelter Activity Standards:
    - Shelter Operations
    - Shelter Safety and Client Standards
    - Household Pets and Service Animals

What to do

Making the decision to evict a client

- Consult the HQ Sheltering Manager, Disaster Mental Health staff, Disaster Health Services staff, HQ Pet Coordinator and other relevant service partners who can provide knowledge or perspective on the situation.
- Consider any unresolved issues, client information, and alternative resolutions before making a final decision.

Notify leadership

- When the decision is made to evict a client, contact the HQ Sheltering Manager or Mass Care or Operations leadership who informs External Relations in advance of potential inquiries from public officials or the media.

Perform the eviction

- Make sure at least two Red Cross workers are present (including the on-duty shelter site leader)
    - It may be helpful to have security and/or law enforcement personnel, and Disaster Mental Health present when that is possible
- Have as few other clients and staff around as possible

- Be calm and firm when informing the client that they must leave the shelter
  - Remember that family members who are not involved in the behavior that led to the eviction are welcome to choose to remain at the shelter

- After you inform the client:
  - Allow them enough time to gather their belongings and pets
  - Remove any wristbands or ID allowing shelter entry
  - Escort the client to the exit
  - Ask the client not to return to the shelter or go to any other Red Cross shelters

Document the details of the eviction

- Record client information, why they were evicted, who handled the eviction, and names of witnessing personnel in SCIA as a comment and in the check-out section
  - If present law enforcement or security were present, record the officer's name, badge number, and case number in the Shelter Site Manager's Log

- Ensure the clienthas been checked out of SCIA, and that their reason for checkout is marked as "*evicted*"
- Inform Shelter Supervisors, reception/registration workers, dormitory workers, security personnel, and the HQ Sheltering Manager.
- Ask the HQ Sheltering Manager about any additional steps that need to be taken.
- The HQ Sheltering Manager determines what to tell the Shelter Site Managers and workers at other shelters about the eviction.

Related Articles

Sheltering Toolkit
Resources for Red Cross workers supporting the sheltering activity during readiness and shelter operations

Questions

For assistance contact **Sheltering@redcross.org**

Evicting a Client from a Shelter V1 2026.05.05 Mass Care - Sheltering

Does this page require a review? Click the link below to inform the author.

Report Content To Author